

REVA ATHLETE WELLNESS PROGRAMME

CLEANSING THE MIND, BODY AND SOUL

The mental health of student-athletes has largely been one of the neglected areas of care in our country. At REVA University, we are constantly looking for ways to develop and enhance how we educate their mind, body, and soul. For the REVA University athletics team, health and wellness have always come first. We ensure that wellness education is provided to students and coaches so that it improves our total health through activities like pre- and post-game consultations, counselling, mind-body programmes, and specialised therapy for athletes.

According to a study titled "Barriers and Facilitators to Mental Health - Seeking for Young Elite Athletes" published in BMC Psychiatry, intervention strategies should concentrate on three key areas to increase help-seeking: educating people about mental health issues, lowering the stigma associated with asking for help and fostering better relationships with potential healthcare providers. At REVA, we made an effort to incorporate these into our athlete wellness programmes by providing a basic support system for our student-athletes. REVA believes that it goes a long way towards making a positive impact in their future.

Dr. P. Shyama Raju, Chancellor of REVA University said that REVA University recognises the need for a specialised wellness programme that has been designed for sportspersons, with their specific and unique needs in mind. "The mental wellness programme is aimed at helping the students handle competitive situations, improve performance, and train them in specific psychological skills so they can cope with failures, maintain their mental balance (anger management, emotionality, etc.), manage their time and effort between sports and academics and work effectively with team members."

REVA University also has a student support service centre Manodhaara which helps students achieve balance and harmony in their lives so that they can thrive academically and personally. We understand that athletes face a variety of challenges that can impact their overall health and well-being. That's why Manodhaara takes a holistic approach to wellness, focusing on the mind, body and soul.

As part of our Athlete Wellness Programmes, we are providing Mind- Body Programme which offers activities focusing on the relationship between mind and body like yoga, meditation, martial arts etc. We also engage in activities like stress reduction and well-being enhancement. We make sure that the programme promotes the growth of compassion, inclusivity, peer-to-peer contact, and mindfulness.

As part of our programme, we also provide preventive care. We provide training and skill-building for athletes and coaches. We also keep an eye on and oversee their well-being. Healthy habits and attitudes are encouraged as part of preventive care, along with adequate physical activity and nutrition, attention to women's health and nutrition, and management of performance anxiety.

Speaking about the Athlete Wellness Programme, Mr Umesh Raju, Pro Chancellor of REVA University said: "We prioritise our students, especially athletes and their relationship with coaches, mentors, as well as with themselves. We take extra care to empower student-athletes. It is important to place our people like coaches, trainers, counsellors, teachers and other administrators at the centre of this work."

At REVA University, we aim to empower students with knowledge. We also include workshops and training in our wellness programme. To deal with trauma, anxiety, panic attacks, and injury, special training courses are provided. Additionally, it offers training on how to control stress tolerance, resilience, and eating and sleeping patterns. With this knowledge and training, students make conscious, healthy decisions, and we encourage them to do the same for their teammates.

Through its athlete wellness programme, REVA University continues to deepen its commitment to fostering the best qualities in its athletes. We pay close attention to the diverse academic, athletic, social, and emotional needs of each student and offer an athlete programme that aids in the development of their physical and mental well-being. It gives them the tools and awareness to embrace all of the obstacles they may face in the future and to confront life with confidence.